

Mine Falls Park Advisory Committee

Meeting Minutes – November 3, 2025

Attendees: Bryan Conant, Paula Lochhead, Natlalie Iucci, Andrew Iucci, Matthew Roscoe, Laura Santer, Dave Silva, Lon Hohberger, Kim Gryslik, Walter Davis, Steve Kenney

Guests: Amanda Griffith (member of Conservation Commission) and Mike Sliwa (Nashua resident)

Call to Order – 7:00 PM

Approval of May Meeting Minutes:

Paula motioned to approve the October Meeting Minutes. Lon seconded this motion. The minutes were unanimously approved without revisions.

New Bench to be Installed

The committee unanimously voted to install a bench (same model as was previously installed) next to the gate house by the red railing. The cost will be \$4,800.

DPW Topics and Projects

- DPW will remove leaves from paved trails within the park. Leaves will be blown to the side of the trail, not vacuumed.
- DPW will also assess erosion throughout the park on unpaved trails in response to voiced concern. Special attention should be given to the area next to the most recently installed bench (~G65) and beneath highway overpass (~G95?).
- 7th St. bridge floor repair remains continuous.

Encampment Remediation

The city has voted to make illegal all camping on public property. This will empower police to enforce this within Mine Falls. Those who are residing at the Pine Street Extension and along Cove Trail will be given notice to vacate on December 1st. Camps will be cleared two weeks after this date. After this occurs, the MFPAC will assess the area and consider what work would be needed to rejuvenate the area and whether the Cove Trail could be reopened in the future.

Matt Sullivan (Economic Development) will be invited to the MFPAC December Meeting to discuss what plans are in store to develop that end of the park. Importantly, it will be necessary to clarify what source of money will fund such developments and which parties (MFPAC, the City, etc.) will be financially responsible for maintaining these developments.

Gate House Updates

Paula and the committee await a final decision this month. The grant, if awarded, would provide \$50,000 and would be matched by \$50,000 from the MFP budget. If funding allows, the pointing on the structure's masonry needs to be redone.

A light within the Gate House requires maintenance. Pete Johnson has assessed damage, and will obtain a mounting plate for repair.

New Table Cloth for Trail Day

Laura will reanimate and share the google form with all committee members. The purpose of this is to generate an email list of trail day volunteers. Lon will order table cloth with QR codes sometime before Spring.

October Trail Day Recap

All projects were productive and successful!

Laura reports that within a 2-hr window on Saturday morning, 102 people (and 25 dogs) entered the park and 104 people (and 26 dogs) left the park via the Lincoln Park entrance. This can be repeated at future trail days to gauge the number of people utilizing the park at different times of year, different times of day, and different entrances.

Future (2026) Trail Day Projects:

- Cleaning of Triangle debris will require a small dump truck or pick-up truck and an alternate method of debris removal (not merely trash bags).
- Dave will identify potential rocks that can be moved within the park and used as benches.
- The metal bench under the pavilion between Whipple St. and 7th St. needs new paint.
- The sign at the Oxbow Lake is falling over and needs to be stabilized.
- Lon will scrape one-inch sections on both wooden bridges. This will help combat ice accumulation in later winter months.

Adjournment – 8:03 PM